

THE DARWIN AWARDS

WHEN IT COMES TO EVOLVING SECURITY MEASURES, SOME PEOPLE JUST GET SKIPPED OVER BY TECHNOLOGY. YOU CAN HELP THEM...OR HAVE SOME FUN!

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he biggest security flaw in any system is much more likely to be human than it is technology. Some of us humans just walk around in a daze from being hit over the head with a silly stick all our lives. Almost all of those same humans seem to get jobs, and chances are, you probably feel like they all got into your office or college on some stupid quota or something. There's a way you can have fun at their expense and also show them why it's important to learn something about technology when they use it. If that's not a win-win for you, then we don't know what can be.

JUST GUESS IT

It's just scary how many people use silly passwords at office. Because it isn't a private computer, and none of their personal data is at risk, they are nonchalant enough to put work data at risk. Show them the importance of being secure everywhere and your company will thank you. You should try and guess passwords, and there's a usual list of passwords that n00bs use. Some even use "password" as their password! However, even if you're in an office where the security policy is

strict and requires long and secure passwords (one uppercase letter, one lower case, at least one number and one special character and no less than 8 characters long, etc) people who use weak passwords will still find a way to use weak passwords, despite all policies. Many will just associate it with something periodic, such as the current month or year. Even if their password is secure, their security question is often too easy. Mother's maiden name? Even a kid with Google skills and a Facebook account can find that out these days!

Once you're in, have some fun, but remember, this is to teach them a lesson. Don't do anything malicious, and nothing that could jeopardise their job.

KEYLOGGERS

Many people don't think twice when their system slows down to a crawl. In fact, many will turn on their PCs, log in and then walk away while it finishes starting up. To teach such people a lesson, installing a keylogger on their PC might be the way to teach them a lesson in security.

Physical keyloggers are available at stores online, but you could make do with a software one as well. You could just install a good keylogging software – such as Reveal Keylogger Free 2.0

– which will send you reports via the internet or LAN. The paid version will even let you transfer files via email and ftp and also take remote screenshots.

PUBLIC WI-FI

Nothing comes for free. Especially Wi-Fi. People don't realise that when they connect to an open Wi-Fi, they're basically risking their systems or phones. Open wifi networks are literally a hacker's dream. Because of poor security on a user's end, hackers can get access to a system, and even snoop on super personal information such as banking or work data.

You can download Wireshark, and connect to an open Wi-Fi network. You can even connect another device to the same network and practice snooping on yourself first, and then use it to snoop on others. Once you have mastered the art, snoop on everyone sitting around a free and open Wi-Fi access point, then laugh in their face as you reveal their personal information to them.

GO PHISHING!

If you go through the spam folder in your email, you will come across many emails that attempt to phish information. Although you will probably die of laughter at the silliness of the scams,